

CLOSE ENCOUNTERS OF THE GODKIND

TEXT: Rev. 1:10-20 (KJV) *“I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day, and heard behind me a great voice, as of a trumpet, ¹¹Saying, **I am Alpha and Omega, the first and the last: and, What thou seest, write in a book, and send it unto the seven churches which are in Asia; unto Ephesus, and unto Smyrna, and unto Pergamos, and unto Thyatira, and unto Sardis, and unto Philadelphia, and unto Laodicea.** ¹²And I turned to see the voice that spake with me. And being turned, I saw seven golden candlesticks; ¹³And in the midst of the seven candlesticks one like unto the Son of man, clothed with a garment down to the foot, and girt about the paps with a golden girdle. ¹⁴His head and his hairs were white like wool, as*

*white as snow; and his eyes were as a flame of fire; ¹⁵And his feet like unto fine brass, as if they burned in a furnace; and his voice as the sound of many waters. ¹⁶And he had in his right hand seven stars: and out of his mouth went a sharp twoedged sword: and his countenance was as the sun shineth in his strength. ¹⁷And when I saw him, I fell at his feet as dead. And he laid his right hand upon me, saying unto me, **Fear not; I am the first and the last: ¹⁸I am he that liveth, and was dead; and, behold, I am alive for evermore, Amen; and have the keys of hell and of death. ¹⁹Write the things which thou hast seen, and the things which are, and the things which shall be hereafter; ²⁰The mystery of the seven stars which thou sawest in my right hand, and the seven golden candlesticks. The seven stars are the angels of the seven churches: and the***

seven candlesticks which thou sawest are the seven churches.”

Matthew 22:1-14 (KJV) *“And Jesus answered and spake unto them again by parables, and said, ²The kingdom of heaven is like unto a certain king, which made a marriage for his son, ³And sent forth his servants to call them that were bidden to the wedding: and they would not come. ⁴Again, he sent forth other servants, saying, Tell them which are bidden, Behold, I have prepared my dinner: my oxen and my fatlings are killed, and all things are ready: come unto the marriage. ⁵But they made light of it, and went their ways, one to his farm, another to his merchandise: ⁶And the remnant took his servants, and entreated them spitefully, and slew them. ⁷But when the king heard thereof, he was wroth: and he sent forth his armies, and destroyed those murderers, and burned up their city. ⁸Then saith he to his*

servants, The wedding is ready, but they which were bidden were not worthy. ⁹Go ye therefore into the highways, and as many as ye shall find, bid to the marriage. ¹⁰So those servants went out into the highways, and gathered together all as many as they found, both bad and good: and the wedding was furnished with guests. ¹¹And when the king came in to see the guests, he saw there a man which had not on a wedding garment: ¹²And he saith unto him, Friend, how camest thou in hither not having a wedding garment? And he was speechless. ¹³Then said the king to the servants, Bind him hand and foot, and take him away, and cast him into outer darkness; there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth. ¹⁴For many are called, but few are chosen.”

INTRO: Our various responses to different kinds of visitors.

- John's situation – Sent to Patmos to die.
- John's Holy visitor - Jesus
- John's Response – Became as dead

Let's look at the response of some other people, when confronted with the presence of the Lord.

I. SAUL WAS CONFRONTED WITH THE PRESENCE OF THE LORD...

Acts 9:1-6 (KJV) *“And Saul, yet breathing out threatenings and slaughter against the disciples of the Lord, went unto the high priest, ²And desired of him letters to Damascus to the synagogues, that if he found any of this way, whether they were men or women, he might bring them bound unto Jerusalem. ³And as he journeyed, he came near Damascus: and suddenly there shined round about him a light from heaven: ⁴And he fell to the earth, and heard a voice saying unto him, Saul, Saul, why*

persecutest thou me? ⁵And he said, Who art thou, Lord? And the Lord said, I am Jesus whom thou persecutest: it is hard for thee to kick against the pricks. ⁶And he trembling and astonished said, Lord, what wilt thou have me to do? And the Lord said unto him, Arise, and go into the city, and it shall be told thee what thou must do.”

Hemphills - *“I’m a winner, I’m a winner, not too far along the way to glory...”*

II. ISAIAH SAW THE LORD...

Isaiah 6:1-8 (KJV) *“In the year that king Uzziah died I saw also the Lord sitting upon a throne, high and lifted up, and his train filled the temple. ²Above it stood the seraphims: each one had six wings; with twain he covered his face, and with twain he covered his feet, and with twain he did fly. ³And one cried unto another, and said, Holy, holy, holy, is the Lord*

of hosts: the whole earth is full of his glory.

⁴And the posts of the door moved at the voice of him that cried, and the house was filled with smoke. ⁵Then said I, Woe is me! For I am undone; because I am a man of unclean lips, and I dwell in the midst of a people of unclean lips: for mine eyes have seen the King, the Lord of hosts. ⁶Then flew one of the seraphims unto me, having a live coal in his hand, which he had taken with the tongs from off the altar: ⁷And he laid it upon my mouth, and said, Lo, this hath touched thy lips; and thine iniquity is taken away, and thy sin purged. ⁸Also I heard the voice of the Lord, saying, Whom shall I send, and who will go for us? Then said I, Here am I; send me.”

Isaiah's response?

- Confession... *“I am undone...”*
- Cleansing... *“He touched my lips...”*

- The call... “*Who will go for us?*”
- A willing heart... “*Here am I, send me...*”

When Moses approached the presence of God he did so making excuses! Once he encountered God’s presence he left ready to face down the Pharaoh of the day.

III. JACOB OBTAINED HIS BLESSING...

Jacob is about to encounter his brother and believes Esau will attempt to murder him. Out of this desperation he goes intentionally encounters God.

Genesis 32:24-30 KJV) “*And Jacob was left alone; and there wrestled a man with him until the breaking of the day.* ²⁵ *And when he saw that he prevailed not against him, he touched the hollow of his thigh; and the hollow of Jacob's thigh was out of joint, as he wrestled with him.* ²⁶ *And he said, Let me go, for the day breaketh. And he said, I will not let thee go,*

except thou bless me. ²⁷ And he said unto him, What is thy name? And he said, Jacob. ²⁸ And he said, Thy name shall be called no more Jacob, but Israel: for as a prince hast thou power with God and with men, and hast prevailed. ²⁹ And Jacob asked him, and said, Tell me, I pray thee, thy name. And he said, Wherefore is it that thou dost ask after my name? And he blessed him there. ³⁰ And Jacob called the name of the place Peniel: for I have seen God face to face, and my life is preserved.”

Notice what happened in this close encounter with God:

- His perseverance was tested... Jacob came into the presence of God in such a place of desperation that not even the pain of a hip out of joint could sideline him? How easily are you to distract in your pursuit of God?

- His life was preserved... I believe Esau intended to kill him but while Jacob met with God and Esau slept the heart of both men was changed!
- His name was changed... Jacob= deceiver (Abraham lied - Isaac lied – When Jacob came along they just named him liar!)
Israel= Prince with God!

IV. MAN MADE SPEECHLESS BY THE PRESENCE OF GOD...

Matthew 22:11-12 (KJV) *“And when the king came in to see the guests, he saw there a man which had not on a wedding garment: ¹²And he saith unto him, Friend, how camest thou in hither not having a wedding garment? And he was speechless.”*

This man probably entered the King’s presence:

- With his excuses well rehearsed...

- His story memorized...
- His claims in hand...

When he actually entered the King's presence he was speechless!

CONCLUSION:

What are you going to do when you stand before him knowing that the secret of every heart is revealed?